

That's exactly how I'd approach it. You're not building a website, you're building a product. The specs are arguably more important than the code because Cursor will only be as good as the instructions it receives.

I would create **25 spec files** and build the platform in this order:

/docs/01-overview.md

<> Markdown



```
# Project Overview
```

```
Build a production-ready dating platform inspired by Secret Benefits.
```

```
Stack:
```

- Next.js 15
- TypeScript
- Tailwind
- Shadcn UI
- Supabase
- PostgreSQL
- Vercel
- Stripe
- Resend
- Cloudflare Images

```
Requirements:
```

- Mobile first
- Server components
- Server actions
- Responsive
- SEO friendly
- Dark mode
- Type-safe
- Loading states
- Error boundaries
- Reusable components

```
Build one feature at a time.
```

```
Never skip steps.
```

```
Always inspect existing files before changing code.
```

/docs/02-project-structure.md

</> Markdown



```
# Folder Structure
```

```
app/
```

```
(auth)
```

```
(discover)
```

```
(profile)
```

```
(messages)
```

```
(account)
```

```
(admin)
```

```
components/
```

```
hooks/
```

```
lib/
```

```
types/
```

```
supabase/
```

```
actions/
```

/docs/03-database.md

Contains:

Tables

- users
- profiles
- photos
- private_albums
- messages
- conversations
- favorites
- visitors
- notifications
- reports
- transactions
- subscriptions
- verification_requests

/docs/04-authentication.md

Pages:

```
/login  
/register  
/forgot-password  
/reset-password
```



Features:

- Supabase Auth
- Email verification
- Middleware protection
- Session management
- Redirect after login

```
/docs/05-onboarding.md
```

Steps:

Step 1

Gender

Step 2

Username

Age

Location

Step 3

Headline

Bio

Occupation

Step 4

Upload photos

Step 5

Finish profile

Progress saved automatically.

/docs/06-discover-feed.md

Features:

Infinite scrolling.

Profile cards.

Favorite button.

Online status.

Verified badge.

Age and city.

Skeleton loading.

Mobile-first grid.

/docs/07-profile-page.md

Sections:

Gallery

Public photos.

Private album preview.

About

Bio

Occupation

Interests

Lifestyle

Sidebar

Message

Favorite

Unlock album

Report profile

/docs/08-search.md

Filters:

- Age
- Distance
- Height
- Body type
- Drinking
- Smoking
- Relationship goals
- Online now
- Verified only

Instant updates.

No page refresh.

/docs/09-messaging.md

Features:

Realtime chat.

Typing indicators.

Read receipts.

Conversation list.

Unread counter.

Image messages.

Emoji support.

Online presence.

Push notifications.

/docs/10-notifications.md

Notification types:

- New message
- Favorite
- Profile visitor
- Album request
- Verification approved

Dropdown panel.

Unread badge.

Mark all as read.

/docs/11-photo-system.md

Public images.

Private albums.

Blur previews.

Compression.

Drag-and-drop upload.

Delete.

Reorder.

/docs/12-credit-system.md

Credit balance.

Packages:

100 credits

500 credits

1000 credits

Spend credits on:

- Message requests
- Unlock albums

- Boost profile

`/docs/13-payments.md`

Stripe integration.

Webhook handling.

Successful purchase flow.

Failed payments.

Transaction history.

`/docs/14-visitors.md`

Track:

Profile views.

Recently viewed.

View counts.

Daily analytics.

`/docs/15-favorites.md`

Favorite users.

Remove favorites.

Favorites page.

Count badges.

`/docs/16-verification.md`

Selfie upload.

ID upload.

Manual approval.

Verified badge.

Verification history.

`/docs/17-admin-dashboard.md`

Manage:

Users.

Photos.

Reports.

Verification queue.

Revenue.

Analytics.

Shadow bans.

`/docs/18-reports.md`

Report:

Spam.

Fake account.

Harassment.

Nudity.

Block users.

`/docs/19-realtime.md`

Supabase realtime:

Presence.

Typing indicators.

Read receipts.

Online users.

/docs/20-api-routes.md

Routes:

```
/api/profile  
/api/photos  
/api/messages  
/api/search  
/api/favorites  
/api/notifications  
/api/payments  
/api/report
```



/docs/21-component-library.md

Components:

```
Navbar  
BottomNav  
ProfileCard  
PhotoCarousel  
FilterSidebar  
ConversationList  
MessageBubble  
NotificationDropdown  
OnlineBadge  
FavoriteButton  
UnlockModal  
CreditCounter  
SkeletonCard  
EmptyState  
ReportModal
```



/docs/22-ui-design-system.md

Shadcn.

8px spacing.

Rounded cards.

Sticky bottom nav.

Large tap targets.

Dark mode.

Framer Motion animations.

`/docs/23-security.md`

Rate limiting.

Middleware.

Input validation.

Zod.

XSS protection.

Spam prevention.

Bot detection.

`/docs/24-deployment.md`

Vercel.

Environment variables.

Supabase keys.

Stripe keys.

Resend keys.

Production domains.

`/docs/25-build-order.md`

- 1 Project setup
- 2 Database



- 3 Auth
- 4 Onboarding
- 5 Discover feed
- 6 Profiles
- 7 Search
- 8 Messaging
- 9 Notifications
- 10 Photo system
- 11 Favorites
- 12 Visitors
- 13 Verification
- 14 Credits
- 15 Payments
- 16 Reports
- 17 Admin dashboard
- 18 Deployment

Cursor Prompt Pattern

Every time:

Read docs/09-messaging.md.

Inspect the existing codebase first.

Explain your implementation plan.

Wait for approval.

Then create complete files using TypeScript, server actions and Shadcn UI.

Do not break existing functionality.



This is very close to how a small engineering team would structure a real production build. With these docs and Cursor, you can realistically build something comparable in functionality without needing to hand-code everything yourself.